

Cache the expensive thing, not everything

IRCTC: WHAT IS WORTH CACHING?

same question from thousands of users

Train list: Delhi → Patna changes once a day	asked 50,000×/hour	CACHE
Seat availability, this train changes every second	asked 50,000×/hour	don't
Your booking history changes rarely	asked once per login	don't

Slow to compute AND often repeated AND stays valid — all three, or don't

Slow and repeated is worth caching; nothing else is

A cache is a bet: **this will be asked again**. Bet wrong and you have added complexity for nothing.

- 1 Cache what is **slow to compute** and **often repeated**.
- 2 Never cache what changes per user per second — you pay the cost, never the benefit.
- 3 Every cache needs an answer to: **when does this become wrong?**

REMEMBER

If you cannot say when an entry goes stale, you are not ready to cache it.

